

Interview Transcription:

Interaction of Driver with Siddarth in Kannada via Phone Call.

Siddarth: How do you receive the details regarding goods pickup and loading/unloading?

Driver: Sir, usually the owner calls me directly and tells the location and type of goods. There is no written format as such, if I forget something, I call him again. Sometimes he sends the contact number of a customer. And also sometimes I don't know the exact quantity of goods, number of labourers involved. My sole job is to get things delivered.

Siddarth: What problems do you face when you go out of the village to deliver goods?

Driver: Sometimes customers do not answer the calls, or the address is confusing in remote village areas. We might have to wait for 1 to 3 hours for the customer or hand it to neighbours unofficially. Another big issue is the network dead-zones. Deep in the farm fields or in building basements, there is zero internet. My phone loses signal, and I cannot notify the owner about the status of delivery. This creates a room for customers to argue with the owner about the billing or delivery time.

Siddarth: How do you decide the route of transportation and navigation?

Driver: We do that mostly based on local experience sir. I know nearby villages within 60 to 100 kms. Even though a precise route planning system is not available. The owner just gives me a paper list of the location and I end up bouncing back and forth across the district. Myself being educated, face some problems in navigating routes, other illiterate drivers face lots of issues regarding this.. It causes wastage of time and fuel, because the route isn't planned in a smart order.

Siddarth: During seasonal demands like the harvesting of crops, what sudden changes do you observe?

Driver: Our peak work time is during this time, we need to transport harvest to APMC market nearby, wait there and do this multiple times in a day, and we do get too many calls. The owner keeps calling to get an update. Sometimes we go out for 3-4 trips in one day on the longer route. Confusion arises regarding which farmer to give priority and serve their needs.

Siddarth: Is there any system to track your working hours in a day?

Driver: No sir. We don't record the start and end time of our working hours. The owner pays us on rough ideas and estimates of our attendance since some days we get longer routes for transportation and sometimes shorter ones.

Summary:

Siddarth interviews a driver working in the local logistics service to understand operational and on-field challenges.

The driver explains that job details are communicated informally through phone calls from the owner, with no written format or structured information. Often, he does not receive complete details about the quantity of goods or number of labourers involved. If he forgets something, he must call back for clarification.

While delivering goods outside the village, he faces several challenges. Customers may be unreachable, addresses in remote areas can be confusing, and he may have to wait 1–3 hours or hand over goods unofficially to neighbours. Network dead zones in farm fields and basements prevent communication with the owner, leading to disputes regarding delivery timing and billing.

Route planning is based mostly on personal experience rather than a proper navigation system. The owner provides only a paper list of locations, causing inefficient back-and-forth travel across the district. This results in time and fuel wastage. Less-educated drivers face even greater navigation difficulties.

During peak harvest seasons, workload increases significantly. Drivers make multiple long trips to APMC markets, receive frequent calls from the owner for updates, and face confusion in prioritizing deliveries. There is no formal system to record working hours; payments are made based on rough attendance estimates.

Overall, the driver highlights issues related to informal communication, incomplete job details, navigation inefficiencies, network limitations, seasonal workload pressure, lack of work-hour tracking, and estimate-based payroll calculations.